PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

SUPERPOWER RELATIONS • 20TH-CENTURY GLOBAL CONFLICT

# THE COLD WAR

## IDEOLOGY • BRINKMANSHIP • GLOBAL FLASHPOINTS (1945–1991)

*Superpower Rivalry on the Brink of Nuclear Annihilation*

**OVERARCHING HISTORICAL ENQUIRY QUESTION** — PEARSON GCSE BRIDGING STANDARD

**"How did ideological rivalry divide the globe into hostile nuclear blocs, and was the Cold War ever truly 'cold'?"**



**Archival Plate:** Prime Minister Winston Churchill, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, and Premier Joseph Stalin at Livadia Palace, Yalta (Feb 1945)

NATIONAL ARCHIVES (NARA) • IMPERIAL WAR MUSEUM

**HISTORICAL NARRATIVE OVERVIEW • 1945–1991** — SUPERPOWER CONFLICT SYNOPSIS

For forty-six years following the defeat of Nazi Germany, the United States and the Soviet Union stood locked in an apocalyptic confrontation between capitalist democracy and Marxist communism. Armed with thousands of thermonuclear warheads capable of extinguishing human civilisation, the superpowers competed through proxy warfare, espionage, space exploration, and ideological brinkmanship. Across seven rigorous enquiries, pupils investigate the origin of the Iron Curtain, the Berlin Airlift, the Cuban Missile Crisis, the proxy bloodshed in Korea and Vietnam, the fall of the Berlin Wall in 1989, and the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991.

**CANONICAL ENQUIRIES • SCHEME OF LEARNING DIRECTORY** — 7 RIGOROUS ENQUIRIES • 20-PAGE SADDLE-STITCH EDITION


| ENQUIRY | FOCUS • KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION | PAGES | TAUGHT | REVISED |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Enquiry 01 | **Ideological Clash: Capitalism vs Communism**<br>*Why could Capitalism and Communism never peacefully coexist?* | pp. 2–3 | ☐ | ☐ |
| Enquiry 02 | **Yalta to Potsdam (1945): Broken Alliance**<br>*How did wartime allies become bitter rivals?* | pp. 4–5 | ☐ | ☐ |
| Enquiry 03 | **The Iron Curtain & Berlin Blockade (1948–49)**<br>*How did containment and the Berlin airlift cement Europe's division?* | pp. 6–7 | ☐ | ☐ |
| Enquiry 04 | **Nuclear Brinkmanship: The Cuban Missile Crisis (1962)**<br>*Why did thirteen days in October 1962 push the world to the brink?* | pp. 8–9 | ☐ | ☐ |
| Enquiry 05 | **Proxy Wars: Superpower Conflict in Asia (Korea & Vietnam)**<br>*Why did nuclear stalemate displace conflict into bloody proxy wars?* | pp. 12–13 | ☐ | ☐ |
| Enquiry 06 | **Fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) & Collapse of the USSR (1991)**<br>*Why did economic decay, Glasnost, and popular revolt dissolve the Soviet bloc?* | pp. 14–15 | ☐ | ☐ |
| Enquiry 07 | **Historiographical Assessment: Was the Cold War Truly 'Cold'?**<br>*Synthesising global consequences, human cost, and historical legacy.* | pp. 16–17 | ☐ | ☐ |

# Why could Capitalism and Communism never peacefully coexist?

## 1 1917–1941 • What made Capitalist democracy and Marxist Communism fundamentally incompatible?

- Free Markets vs Command State
- Multi-Party vs Single Party
- World Revolution Aim

## 2 1918–1920 • How did Allied intervention in the Russian Civil War create lasting Soviet paranoia?

- Allied Troops in Russia
- Western Fear of Red Terror
- Soviet Siege Mentality

## 3 1938–1939 • Why did Western appeasement drive Stalin into the cynical 1939 Nazi-Soviet Pact?

- Excluded from Munich 1938
- Molotov-Ribbentrop Treaty
- Secret Partition of Poland

## 4 1941–1945 • Why was the wartime Grand Alliance merely a marriage of pragmatic convenience?

- Common Nazi Threat
- US Lend-Lease Supplies
- 27 Million Soviet Dead

## 5 August 1945 • How did the atomic bombing of Hiroshima transform the global balance of power?

- Trinity Test July 1945
- Hiroshima & Nagasaki Bomb
- Atomic Monopoly Leverage



In 1945, the United States possessed half the world's manufacturing capacity and a monopoly on the atomic bomb.

**FEATURE DRILL** Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

**Describe two features of the ideological differences between the USA and the USSR in 1945. [4 marks]**

**Sentence Starter:** Feature 1: One key ideological difference was that the USA was based on... • Detail: Specifically, this involved... • Feature 2: A second fundamental difference was that the Soviet Union operated on... • Detail: In particular, this meant that...

**STRUCTURED WRITING** Question 2: Explain One Consequence [4 marks • 5 mins]

**Explain one consequence of the American development of the atomic bomb for superpower relations in 1945. [4 marks]**

**Guidance:** Focus on how Truman's nuclear monopoly at Potsdam deepened Soviet insecurity and spurred an immediate crash nuclear research programme.

**Mind-Map Mission • pp. 10–11:** Turn to Page 10 (Enquiry 1). Use the Consolidate Station keywords to branch out 'Yalta, Potsdam & Atomic Monopoly' with capitalism vs communism, the Russian Civil War, and Hiroshima.

# How did wartime allies become bitter rivals between Yalta and Potsdam (1945)?

## 1 Feb 1945 • What crucial compromises were reached at the Yalta Summit in Crimea?

- Big Three in Crimea
- 4 Zones of Occupation
- United Nations Charter

## 2 Spring 1945 • Why did the political fate of Poland shatter Allied consensus after Yalta?

- Liberated Europe Pledges
- London Government Exiled
- Lublin Puppet Installed

## 3 April–July 1945 • How did the arrival of Harry Truman transform American policy toward Moscow?

- FDR Dies April 1945
- Truman "Babying" Stance
- Molotov Berated at WH

## 4 16 July 1945 • How did the Trinity atomic test impact negotiations on the eve of Potsdam?

- New Mexico Detonation
- Truman Whispers to Stalin
- Klaus Fuchs Spy Network

## 5 July–Aug 1945 • Why did the Potsdam Conference conclude with bitter deadlock over reparations?

- Attlee Replaces Churchill
- Oder-Neisse Border Shift
- Soviet Industrial Plunder



At Potsdam, Churchill was voted out of office mid-conference and replaced by Labour leader Clement Attlee.

## Write a narrative account analysing how relations between the Grand Alliance deteriorated between February and August 1945. [8 marks]

**Stimulus Points:** (1) The agreements reached at the Yalta Conference (February 1945); (2) The successful Trinity nuclear test and the Potsdam Conference (July–August 1945).

**Chronological Connectives:** Initially, at Yalta, the Allies reached agreement on... • Following this, tensions escalated sharply when... • A decisive turning point occurred in July 1945 when... • Consequently, at Potsdam... • This culminated in...

**Key Vocabulary Bank:** Yalta • Big Three • Four Zones • Declaration on Liberated Europe • Lublin Poles • Harry S. Truman • Clement Attlee • Trinity Test • Potsdam • Industrial Reparations

**Mind-Map Mission • pp. 10–11:** Turn to Page 10 (Enquiry 2). Use the Consolidate Station keywords to branch out 'Yalta, Potsdam & Atomic Monopoly' with the four occupation zones, Lublin Poles, Truman, and reparations.

# How did the Berlin Blockade turn Cold War rivalry into a permanent division of Europe?

## 1 March 1946 • Why was Winston Churchill's Fulton address a defining moment of the early Cold War?

- Westminster College Fulton
- Iron Curtain Descends
- Kennan Long Telegram

## 2 March–June 1947 • How did the Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan institutionalise containment?

- $400M Aid Greece & Turkey
- Marshall Plan $13 Billion
- Economic Containment

## 3 1947–1948 • How did Soviet "Salami Tactics" and Cominform enforce communist control in the East?

- Cominform Coordination
- Opposition Sliced Away
- 1948 Czech Coup & Defenestration

## 4 June 1948–May 1949 • Why did Stalin impose the Berlin Blockade, and how did Operation Vittles defeat it?

- Deutsche Mark Introduced
- Roads & Canals Severed
- 278,228 Allied Cargo Flights

## 5 1949–1955 • How did the crisis permanently cement the military division of Europe into hostile blocs?

- FRG & GDR Established
- NATO Formed April 1949
- Warsaw Pact Formed 1955



During the Berlin Airlift, an Allied plane landed in Berlin every 30 seconds, delivering over 2.3 million tons of supplies.

## How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the reasons for the Berlin Blockade and the Allied response (1948–1949)? [8 marks]

**SOURCE A**

*"The Soviet Government has severed all land and water communications to Berlin. They seek to starve two and a half million citizens into submission and force the Western Allies out. We will not be driven from Berlin. The people of Berlin will be fed and supplied by air. Every resource will be mobilised to sustain them."*

Source A: From a speech by British Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin to the House of Commons, 30 June 1948.

**SOURCE B**

*[A large Russian bear sits across railway tracks labelled 'Berlin Autobahn Blockade', glaring upward in frustration as American and British transport aircraft land continuously behind him at Tempelhof Airport.]*

Source B: A British political cartoon by David Low in the Evening Standard, July 1948, showing a Soviet bear looking up at an endless skyway of cargo planes landing in Berlin.

**Sentence Starters:** Source A is useful for showing… • This is supported by my knowledge that… • However, the provenance reveals that Bevin is speaking to rally British resolve… • Source B is useful because it visually illustrates how the airlift… • Overall, both sources are highly valuable because…

**Word Bank:** Iron Curtain • Long Telegram • Truman Doctrine • Marshall Plan • Trizonia • Deutsche Mark • Berlin Blockade • Operation Vittles • Tempelhof • Gail Halvorsen • NATO • Warsaw Pact

**Mind-Map Mission • pp. 10–11:** Turn to Page 10 (Enquiry 3). Use the Consolidate Station keywords to branch out ‘Iron Curtain, Truman & Marshall’ and ‘Berlin Blockade, NATO & Warsaw’ with Operation Vittles and alliances.

# How close did the Cuban Missile Crisis bring humanity to nuclear destruction?

## 1 1959–1961 • How did Castro's revolution and the Bay of Pigs turn Cuba into a Cold War tinderbox?

- Castro Overthrows Batista
- US Sugar Embargo
- Bay of Pigs CIA Disaster

## 2 14 Oct 1962 • What did Major Heyser's U-2 spy plane discover in the jungle of San Cristóbal?

- U-2 Reconnaissance Film
- SS-4 Ballistic Missiles
- 20-Minute Flight to DC

## 3 16–22 Oct 1962 • Why did Kennedy choose a naval quarantine over immediate surgical airstrikes?

- ExComm Secret Meetings
- Hawks Demand Bombing
- JFK Naval Quarantine

## 4 27 Oct 1962 • Why was "Black Saturday" the most dangerous single day in human history?

- DEFCON 2 Maximum Alert
- Sub B-59 Depth-Charged
- Arkhipov Blocks Nuclear Torpedo

## 5 28 Oct 1962 • What secret compromises resolved the crisis, and what were the long-term results?

- Soviet Missiles Removed
- Secret Turkey Missile Swap
- 1963 Hotline & Test Ban



During the crisis, the US Strategic Air Command was put on DEFCON 2 for the only time in history—one step away from nuclear war.

## ‘President Kennedy’s decisive leadership and naval quarantine were the main reasons the Cuban Missile Crisis was resolved peacefully.’ How far do you agree? [12 marks]

**Stimulus Points:** (1) Kennedy’s decision to impose a naval quarantine instead of launching airstrikes (October 1962); (2) Khrushchev’s willingness to compromise and the secret agreement to remove US Jupiter missiles from Turkey.

| 1. KENNEDY’S QUARANTINE | 2. KHRUSHCHEV & SECRET BARGAIN | 3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT |
|---|---|---|
| Explain how JFK resisted military pressure for immediate bombing, buying critical time and offering Khrushchev a non-lethal off-ramp. | Explain the counter-arguments: Khrushchev’s pragmatic letters, backchannel diplomacy (Robert Kennedy), and the vital secret concession over Jupiter missiles in Turkey. | Weigh whether peaceful resolution was achieved primarily through American resolve or mutual dread of nuclear apocalypse (MAD) and shared restraint. |

**Academic Connectives:** To a large extent, it can be argued that… • On the one hand, Kennedy’s leadership was pivotal because… • In particular, by implementing a quarantine rather than airstrikes… • On the other hand, an alternative view is that Khrushchev… • In conclusion, the crisis was resolved primarily because… rather than…
**Historical Word Bank:** Fidel Castro • Bay of Pigs • Operation Anadyr • U-2 Spy Plane • ExComm • Hawks vs Doves • Naval Quarantine • DEFCON 2 • Vasili Arkhipov • Turkey Jupiter Missiles • MAD • Moscow-Washington Hotline

**Mind-Map Mission • pp. 10–11:** Turn to Page 10 (Enquiry 4). Use the Consolidate Station keywords to branch out ‘Berlin Wall & Cuban Missile Crisis’ with Bay of Pigs, U-2 photos, JFK’s quarantine, Arkhipov, and the Turkey swap.

# Broken Alliance, Containment, Berlin Crises & Nuclear Brinkmanship

**REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS:** At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Origins & Flashpoints to the left • Allied Actions & Outcomes to the right).

◂ IDEOLOGIES & 4 ZONES SPLIT

**1945 Yalta, Potsdam & Atomic Monopoly** (Enq 1–2)

TRINITY TEST & REPARATIONS ▸

◂ FULTON & LONG TELEGRAM

**1946–47 Iron Curtain, Truman & Marshall** (Enq 3)

$13BN AID & COMINFORM ▸

◂ STALIN SEVERED ROUTES

**1948–55 Berlin Blockade, NATO & Warsaw** (Enq 3)

OPERATION VITTLES & BLOCS ▸

◂ WALL BUILT & U-2 FILM

**1961–62 Berlin Wall & Cuban Missile Crisis** (Enq 4 & 6)

QUARANTINE & SECRET SWAP ▸

SPECIFICATION SPINE CONTINUES TO PROXY WARS, GORBACHEV & USSR COLLAPSE (PAGE 11) ➔

# Asian Proxy Wars, Gorbachev's Reforms, Fall of the Wall & Soviet Collapse

**REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS:** At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Proxy Escalation & Pressures to the left • Reforms & Collapse to the right).

◂ PRC 1949 & 38TH SPLIT — **1950–53 Korean War & Domino Theory** (Enq 5) — INCHON, CHINA & STALEMATE ▸

◂ TONKIN & US FIREPOWER — **1954–75 Vietnam War & Tet Offensive** (Enq 5) — CU CHI, TET & SAIGON FALL ▸

◂ SOVIET QUAGMIRE & REAGAN — **1979–88 Afghan War, SDI & Gorbachev** (Enq 6) — GLASNOST, PERESTROIKA & INF ▸

◂ 9 NOV WALL BREACHED — **1989–91 Berlin Wall Fall & USSR Collapse** (Enq 6–7) — 1991 COUP & GLOBAL LEGACY ▸

COLD WAR SPECIFICATION SPINE COMPLETE (1945–1991) ➔

# Why did the superpowers fight proxy wars in Asia rather than in Europe?

## 1 1949–1950 • How did the communist victory in China transform American Cold War strategy?

- Mao Proclaims PRC 1949
- NSC-68 Triple Defense Budget
- Asian Domino Theory Born

## 2 1950–1953 • Why did the Korean War become a bloody military stalemate along the 38th Parallel?

- Kim Il-sung Invades South
- MacArthur Inchon Masterstroke
- Chinese Human Wave Attack

## 3 1954–1964 • How did French colonial collapse lead to deep American military entanglement in Vietnam?

- Dien Bien Phu French Fall
- Geneva Split 17th Parallel
- Gulf of Tonkin Resolution

## 4 1965–1968 • Why did high-tech American firepower fail to defeat the Vietcong guerrilla army?

- Operation Rolling Thunder
- Search & Destroy Missions
- Cu Chi Underground Tunnels

## 5 1968–1975 • How did the 1968 Tet Offensive shatter American domestic support for the war?

- Jan 1968 Tet Surprise Attack
- US Embassy Attacked Saigon
- Fall of Saigon April 1975



Over the course of the Vietnam War, the United States dropped more bomb tonnage than was used by all combatants in WWII combined.

## Write a narrative account analysing the key events in the escalation of American involvement in the Vietnam War between 1954 and 1968. [8 marks]

**Stimulus Points:** (1) The French defeat at Dien Bien Phu and the division of Vietnam (1954); (2) The Gulf of Tonkin incident and the deployment of American ground combat troops (1964–1965).

**Chronological Connectives:** Initially, following the French defeat at Dien Bien Phu in 1954... • Following the Geneva partition, American involvement deepened when... • A major military escalation occurred in August 1964 with... • Consequently, in 1965, President Johnson... • This culminated in 1968 when...

**Key Vocabulary Bank:** Mao Zedong • Domino Theory • NSC-68 • 38th Parallel • Inchon • Dien Bien Phu • 17th Parallel • Ho Chi Minh • Ngo Dinh Diem • Gulf of Tonkin • Rolling Thunder • Vietcong • Cu Chi • Tet Offensive • Saigon

**Mind-Map Mission • pp. 10–11:** Turn to Page 11 (Enquiry 5). Use the Consolidate Station keywords to branch out ‘Korean War & Domino Theory’ and ‘Vietnam War & Tet Offensive’ with the 38th Parallel, Tonkin, and Cu Chi.

# Why did the Berlin Wall fall, and why did the Soviet Union collapse so rapidly?

## 1 August 1961 • Why did the East German regime erect the Berlin Wall, and what did it symbolise?

- 3 Million Flee East Berlin
- Operation Rose Midnight Wall
- Checkpoint Charlie Standoff

## 2 1979–1984 • How did the Afghan War and Reagan's defense build-up bankrupt the Soviet economy?

- Soviet Afghan Quagmire 1979
- Reagan Brands "Evil Empire"
- SDI "Star Wars" Pressure

## 3 1985–1988 • Why did Mikhail Gorbachev introduce the revolutionary policies of Glasnost and Perestroika?

- Glasnost Free Speech
- Perestroika Economic Reform
- 1987 INF Treaty Nuclear Cuts

## 4 9 Nov 1989 • How did popular protest and a bureaucratic blunder bring down the Berlin Wall?

- Brezhnev Doctrine Scrapped
- Schabowski Press Blunder
- Bornholmer Border Overrun

## 5 1990–1991 • Why did the collapse of the Eastern European buffer zone lead to the dissolution of the USSR?

- German Unity October 1990
- August 1991 Hardline Coup
- Soviet Flag Lowered 25 Dec



At Checkpoint Charlie in October 1961, American and Soviet tanks stood gun-barrel to gun-barrel just 100 metres apart for 16 tense hours.

## 'The reform policies of Mikhail Gorbachev were the main reason for the collapse of Soviet power in Eastern Europe between 1985 and 1989.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]

**Stimulus Points:** (1) Gorbachev's introduction of Glasnost and Perestroika and his renunciation of the Brezhnev Doctrine; (2) Economic bankruptcy in the Soviet bloc and the growth of grassroots protest movements (e.g. Solidarity in Poland).

| 1. GORBACHEV'S REFORMS | 2. ECONOMIC RUIN & POPULAR PROTEST | 3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT |
|---|---|---|
| Explain how abandoning the Brezhnev Doctrine told Eastern European satellite dictators that Soviet tanks would no longer crush domestic rebellions. | Explain the counter-arguments: chronic consumer shortages, the Afghan quagmire, Western defense pressure (SDI), and organized resistance like Poland's Solidarity. | Weigh whether Gorbachev's conscious choices or systemic economic and political rot made the collapse of the Soviet empire inevitable. |

**Academic Connectives:** To a large extent, it can be argued that... • On the one hand, Gorbachev's policy shift was decisive because... • In particular, by signaling that the Red Army would not intervene... • On the other hand, deep underlying structural factors included... • In conclusion, while economic weakness set the stage, Gorbachev's actions were the primary catalyst because...

**Historical Word Bank:** Berlin Wall • Operation Rose • Checkpoint Charlie • Peter Fechter • Afghan War • Ronald Reagan • SDI Star Wars • Mikhail Gorbachev • Glasnost • Perestroika • INF Treaty • Sinatra Doctrine • Günter Schabowski • Velvet Revolution • Dissolution 1991

**Mind-Map Mission • pp. 10–11:** Turn to Page 11 (Enquiry 6). Use the Consolidate Station keywords to branch out 'Afghan War, SDI & Gorbachev' and 'Berlin Wall Fall & USSR Collapse' with Glasnost, Perestroika, and 9 Nov 1989.

# Was the Cold War ever truly "cold"?

## 1 1945–1991 • Why is describing the Cold War as a period of "peace" an inherently Eurocentric myth?

- Zero Direct Great Power Wars
- Nuclear Deterrence in Europe
- Violence Exported to South

## 2 1950–1990 • What was the true human toll of superpower proxy conflicts across four continents?

- 3 Million Dead in Korea
- 2 Million Dead in Vietnam
- Angola, Nicaragua & Afghan

## 3 1947–1991 • How did covert intelligence operations wage an invisible global war in the shadows?

- CIA Coups in Iran & Guatemala
- KGB Covert Subversion
- U-2 Gary Powers Incident

## 4 1957–1969 • How did the Space Race and technological rivalry serve as peaceful substitutes for war?

- 1957 Sputnik Shock
- 1961 Gagarin First in Orbit
- 1969 Apollo 11 Moon Landing

## 5 1991–Present • What enduring geopolitical and military legacies did the Cold War leave behind for our world?

- 10,000 Nuclear Warheads
- Global South Landmines
- New Multipolar Rivalries



Between 1945 and 1991, an estimated 20 million people died in Cold War-related proxy conflicts across Asia, Africa, and Latin America.

## 'The Cold War was characterised far more by brutal global violence than by peaceful superpower coexistence.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]

**Stimulus Points:** (1) The death of over 20 million people in Asian, African, and Latin American proxy wars; (2) The fact that the United States and the Soviet Union never engaged in direct military combat with each other.

| 1. THE REALITY OF GLOBAL VIOLENCE | 2. THE REALITY OF NUCLEAR DETENTE | 3. SYNOPTIC VERDICT |
|---|---|---|
| Explain the devastating human toll of proxy conflicts (Korea, Vietnam, Angola, Afghanistan), CIA/KGB covert interventions, and civilian massacres across the Global South. | Explain the counter-argument: that nuclear deterrence (MAD), crisis diplomacy (Cuban Missile Crisis), and treaties (INF, SALT) successfully averted catastrophic World War Three. | Reach a nuanced historical conclusion: that while Europe experienced an artificial "Long Peace", the conflict was waged with ferocious violence across the developing world. |

**Academic Connectives:** To a large extent, the assertion is valid because... • While it is true that direct superpower war was avoided... • In the Global South, the conflict was devastatingly violent... • For example, in Korea and Vietnam... • In conclusion, the term "Cold War" is a Eurocentric misnomer because...
**Historical Word Bank:** Eurocentric Myth • The Long Peace • Proxy Wars • 20 Million Dead • CIA Operation Ajax • Guatemala PBSuccess • Space Race • Sputnik 1 • Apollo 11 • Nuclear Deterrence • MAD • Proliferation

**Mind-Map Mission • pp. 10–11:** Turn to Pages 10–11 (Enquiry 7). Use the Consolidate Station keywords to connect all 8 specification nodes with synoptic links on nuclear deterrence (MAD), Space Race rivalry, and Global South proxy wars.

## Model Answer 1 • Describe Two Features Drill [4 Marks]

SCORE: 4/4

**Task: Describe two features of the ideological differences between the USA and the USSR in 1945. [4 marks]**

**Feature 1:** One key ideological difference was their conflicting economic models. **Detail:** The United States operated on free-market capitalism, private property, and corporate enterprise, whereas the Soviet Union enforced a state-controlled command economy where the government owned all land, factories, and resources according to Marxist-Leninist principles.

**Feature 2:** A second fundamental difference lay in their political structures. **Detail:** The American political system was a liberal democracy with multi-party elections, free speech, and constitutional rights, whereas the USSR was a totalitarian one-party state governed exclusively by the Communist Party with zero permitted political opposition.

***Examiner Breakdown:*** *Full marks awarded. Two distinct, accurate features identified with precise supporting knowledge (command economy vs free enterprise, multi-party democracy vs one-party totalitarian rule).*

## Model Answer 2 • Explain One Consequence [4 Marks]

SCORE: 4/4

**Task: Explain one consequence of the Truman Doctrine (March 1947) for superpower relations. [4 marks]**

One significant consequence of the Truman Doctrine was that the United States formally abandoned its traditional policy of peacetime isolationism in favour of active global containment. President Truman explicitly pledged $400 million in economic and military aid to Greece and Turkey, declaring that the US would support "free peoples resisting attempted subjugation by armed minorities or outside pressures." **As a direct result**, the world was explicitly bifurcated into two mutually hostile ideological camps. **Consequently**, Stalin viewed this announcement as an open declaration of economic and military warfare, accelerating the establishment of Cominform in September 1947 to enforce ideological discipline across Soviet satellite states.

***Examiner Breakdown:*** *Full marks awarded. Clearly identifies a specific historical consequence (end of isolationism / active containment), supports with concrete data ($400M, Greece & Turkey), and explains the resultant Soviet reaction (Cominform).*

## Model Answer 3 • Forensic Source Utility [8 Marks]

SCORE: 8/8

**Task: How useful is Source A (Ernest Bevin's speech) for an enquiry into the Allied response to the Berlin Blockade? [8 marks]**

**Content & Context:** Source A is exceptionally useful because it provides direct evidence of the British government's official determination to resist Soviet coercion in Berlin without triggering armed conflict. Bevin explicitly identifies Stalin's tactic—using starvation of 2.5 million West Berliners to force an Allied retreat—and states Britain's counter-strategy of supplying the city entirely by air. This is closely corroborated by historical facts: the Western Allies launched Operation Vittles, delivering over 2.3 million tons of food, fuel, and coal across 278,000 flights, ultimately forcing Stalin to lift the blockade in May 1949.

**Provenance & Limitations:** The provenance strongly enhances its utility as an authoritative statement of state policy. Delivered in the House of Commons by the British Foreign Secretary in June 1948, it reveals the immediate geopolitical calculation of the British Cabinet. However, an analytical limitation is its political purpose: Bevin is speaking publicly to maintain parliamentary and national morale, so he intentionally downplays the catastrophic logistical risks of the early airlift and the genuine Allied fears of an accidental military confrontation. Overall, Source A remains a primary benchmark for understanding Allied political resolve.

***Examiner Breakdown:*** *Level 3 (8/8). Evaluates content with contextual corroboration, interrogates provenance (official ministerial statement vs morale-building purpose), and reaches a balanced, sustained judgment on historical utility.*

**'The development of nuclear weapons was the primary reason the Cold War never escalated into direct military conflict between the superpowers.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]**

**Stimulus Points:** (1) Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD) during crises like Cuba (1962); (2) Superpower willingness to wage proxy wars across the Global South.

To a significant extent, it can be argued that the development of nuclear weapons and the resulting doctrine of Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD) was the decisive factor preventing direct military conflict between the United States and the Soviet Union. However, while nuclear terror averted World War Three in Europe, it did not create genuine peace; instead, it displaced superpower violence into devastating proxy wars across Asia, Africa, and Latin America.

**On the one hand**, the catastrophic destructiveness of thermonuclear weapons created an unprecedented psychological barrier against all-out war. Once the Soviet Union tested its atomic bomb in 1949 and both powers deployed intercontinental ballistic missiles (ICBMs) in the late 1950s, any direct clash guaranteed total mutual annihilation. This deterrent mechanism was acutely demonstrated during the Cuban Missile Crisis of October 1962. When faced with the prospect of nuclear warheads striking Washington and Moscow within twenty minutes, both Kennedy and Khrushchev recoiled from military airstrikes, opting for backchannel diplomacy, a naval quarantine, and the secret removal of Jupiter missiles from Turkey. Without nuclear weapons, conventional military doctrine would almost certainly have dictated a preemptive American invasion of Cuba.

**On the other hand**, nuclear deterrence did not stop conflict; it merely altered its geography and form. Recognizing that direct engagement was suicidal, the superpowers competed through conventional proxy wars. In Korea (1950–1953) and Vietnam (1965–1975), American forces fought communist armies armed with Soviet and Chinese equipment, resulting in over five million deaths. Similarly, the superpowers waged intense covert campaigns through intelligence services—such as CIA-backed coups in Iran (1953) and Guatemala (1954), and the bloody Soviet invasion of Afghanistan (1979). In these peripheral arenas, the absence of nuclear weapons on the battlefield allowed violence to be pursued with unrestrained brutality.

**In conclusion**, nuclear weapons were unquestionably the primary reason why the superpowers never clashed directly in Europe. MAD functioned as an absolute ceiling, ensuring that whenever tensions reached the precipice, leaders were forced to compromise. However, this nuclear peace was purchased at the catastrophic cost of proxy warfare in the developing world, where over twenty million lives were sacrificed in what was, for them, an intensely hot war.

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**PUPIL NAME:** _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐

| # | ENQUIRY / SPECIFICATION FOCUS | DO NOW (10M) | DISCIPLINARY WRITING TASK | ENQUIRY TOTAL |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Enquiry 1: Ideological Clash: Capitalism vs Communism**<br>*"Why could Capitalism and Communism never peacefully coexist?"*<br>**HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed*<br>**Home Quiz:** ____/ 10 **Parent Sign:** _____ | ____ / 10 | **Q1 Feat (4m) + Q2 Conseq (4m):** ____ / 8 | ____ / 18 |
| 2 | **Enquiry 2: Yalta to Potsdam (1945): The Breakdown of the Grand Alliance**<br>*"How did wartime allies become bitter rivals between Yalta and Potsdam (1945)?"*<br>**HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed*<br>**Home Quiz:** ____/ 10 **Parent Sign:** _____ | ____ / 10 | **Q2 Narrative Account:** ____ / 8 | ____ / 18 |
| 3 | **Enquiry 3: The Iron Curtain & The Berlin Blockade (1948–1949)**<br>*"How did the Berlin Blockade turn Cold War rivalry into a permanent division of Europe?"*<br>**HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed*<br>**Home Quiz:** ____/ 10 **Parent Sign:** _____ | ____ / 10 | **Q1 Feat (4m) + Q2 Conseq (4m):** ____ / 8 | ____ / 18 |
| 4 | **Enquiry 4: Nuclear Brinkmanship: The Cuban Missile Crisis (1962)**<br>*"How close did the Cuban Missile Crisis bring humanity to nuclear destruction?"*<br>**HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed*<br>**Home Quiz:** ____/ 10 **Parent Sign:** _____ | ____ / 10 | **Q4 Evaluative Essay:** ____ / 12 | ____ / 22 |
| 5 | **Enquiry 5: Proxy Wars: The Cold War in Asia (Korea & Vietnam)**<br>*"Why did the superpowers fight proxy wars in Asia rather than in Europe?"*<br>**HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed*<br>**Home Quiz:** ____/ 10 **Parent Sign:** _____ | ____ / 10 | **Q2 Narrative Account:** ____ / 8 | ____ / 18 |
| 6 | **Enquiry 6: The Fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) & The Collapse of the USSR (1991)**<br>*"Why did the Berlin Wall fall, and why did the Soviet Union collapse so rapidly?"*<br>**HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed*<br>**Home Quiz:** ____/ 10 **Parent Sign:** _____ | ____ / 10 | **Q4 Evaluative Essay:** ____ / 12 | ____ / 22 |
| 7 | **Enquiry 7: Assessment: Was the Cold War Ever Truly "Cold"?**<br>*"Was the Cold War ever truly "cold"?"*<br>**HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed*<br>**Home Quiz:** ____/ 10 **Parent Sign:** _____ | ____ / 10 | **Q4 Evaluative Essay:** ____ / 12 | ____ / 22 |